03-02 第2篇

阅读理解（说明文） How Do Birds Find Their Way Home?

① Every autumn, millions of birds fly south; every spring, they fly back north to the very same tree, the very same roof, sometimes even the very same nest. People have wondered about this for thousands of years. How can a small bird travel ten thousand kilometres and still find one garden in Beijing? Scientists today believe the answer is not magic, but a set of clever natural tools inside the bird's body.

② The first tool is the **sun**. During the day, a bird can check the position of the sun and feel the time of day. Its small brain works like a simple clock. If the sun is on its right in the morning, the bird knows it is flying south. When clouds cover the sky, this method does not work well, so birds must use other tools.

③ The second tool is the **stars**. Many birds fly at night to avoid hot weather and hungry eagles. When they are young, they lie in the nest and watch the night sky turn slowly around one fixed point — the Pole Star. They seem to remember this picture, and later use it as a map when they travel. In one famous test in the 1960s, scientists put young birds in a sky-show room with different "stars". When they later flew free, they followed the fake stars, not the real ones. This showed that star-reading is something they **learn**, not something they are born knowing.

④ The third tool is surprising: the **Earth's magnetic field**. Our planet acts like a big, invisible magnet, and birds can feel it. Tiny bits of a special material in their eyes and beaks help them sense the north—south lines. This "inner compass" still works on cloudy nights, above the sea, or inside a thick forest, so it is often the most reliable tool of all.

⑤ Finally, birds also use **smell, shape of the land, and memory**. They remember the shape of a big river, the smell of a pine forest, or the colour of a lake. Putting all these tools together, a bird can correct small mistakes during the trip, just as we use both a phone map and street signs to find a new restaurant. Nature, it turns out, has already given birds their own GPS — long before humans invented ours.

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What question does the passage mainly try to answer?

A. Why do birds need to fly south every winter?
B. How can birds find the way back to the same place?

C. Which bird flies the farthest in the world?
D. Why are some birds afraid of eagles?

2. According to Paragraph 2, how does the sun help a bird travel?

A. It makes the bird feel warm and happy.
B. It tells the bird where to look for food.
C. It works together with the bird's inner clock to show direction.
D. It changes the colour of the bird's feathers.

3. What did the 1960s "sky-show room" test show?

A. Young birds can only fly during the day.
B. Birds must use the Pole Star to fly north.
C. Birds learn to read the stars when they are young.
D. Stars are not useful to birds at all.

4. Why is the Earth's magnetic field often the most reliable tool for birds?

A. It is faster than the sun and the stars.
B. It works even on cloudy nights, at sea, or in thick forests.
C. It helps birds see colours more clearly.
D. It makes their feathers stronger.

5. What does the underlined word "reliable" in Paragraph 4 most probably mean?

A. 容易损坏的
B. 可以信赖的
C. 少见的
D. 昂贵的

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第①段末两句 + 全文
【解析】文章以"一只小鸟如何飞越万里仍找到北京的某个花园"开篇，随后逐段介绍鸟的"导航工具"。A 项"为什么南飞"未作解释；C 项"飞得最远"未涉及；D 项仅是第③段一处细节，以偏概全。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段第 2—3 句 "check the position of the sun and feel the time of day. Its

small brain works like a simple clock."
【解析】鸟靠"太阳+体内时钟"判断方向。A 项"感到温暖高兴"、B 项"寻找食物"、D 项"改变羽色"均无依据。故选 C。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】第③段末句 "star-reading is something they learn, not something they are born knowing"
【解析】实验结论是识星能力是**后天学习**的。A 项与"Many birds fly at night"矛盾；B 项推断过度；D 项与实验结果相反。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第④段末句 "still works on cloudy nights, above the sea, or inside a thick forest"
【解析】磁场工具在其他方法失效时仍能工作，因此最可靠。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】词义猜测题
【定位】第④段末句上下文
【解析】前句说磁场在阴天、海上、密林中仍能使用，说明它"最值得信赖"，reliable = 可靠的/可以信赖的。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **compass** [n.] 指南针
- **magnetic field** 磁场
- **Pole Star** 北极星